***Board 1***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 4 3
♥ A K Q J
♦ A K
♣ A K Q 5 2

♠ J 10 8 6
♥ 9 7
♦ 10 8 3
♣ J 9 8 4

♠ 9
♥ 10 5 3 2
♦ Q J 9 6 4 2
♣ 10 7

♠ A K Q 7 5 2
♥ 8 6 4
♦ 7 5
♣ 6 3

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♠ |
| Pass | 2NT | Pass | 3NT |
| Pass | 7NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

7NT by North
Lead: ♦Q

West follows twice, then discards 2 ♦s.

Don't play ♠s yet!

Play your ♦A. West must give up.

If he throws the ♣J, you win. But if he throws a ♠ you also win. This is what is called a Win-Win bridge play.

South's 3NT rebid shows 6 ♠s headed by A K Q and nothing else. North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♦Q.

Nice hand. You have 12 high card tricks and either a 3-2 ♠ split or a 3-3 ♣ split will land this Grand Slam. But even if neither suit splits nicely you can STILL make it if the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits; in that case you will squeeze for the thirteenth trick.

You win the ♦K.

Win the ♦K and (**IMPORTANT!**) test the ♣s first by playing ♣ A K Q. Darn. East discards a ♦ on the ♣Q.

Alright, so West holds the ♣ Guard. You still need to exercise caution.

Play your 4 ♥ winner's next. East follows suit while

***Board 2***
East Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 10 6<br>♥ A K 8 6<br>♦ 9 7 3<br>♣ A K Q J | |
| ♠ 8 5 3<br>♥ Q 10 7 2<br>♦ J 10 8 4<br>♣ 6 3 | | ♠ 9 7 4 2<br>♥ J 4<br>♦ A 6 5 2<br>♣ 9 5 2 |
| | ♠ A K Q J<br>♥ 9 5 3<br>♦ K Q<br>♣ 10 8 7 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | Pass | 1NT |
| Pass | 2♣ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 6NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6NT by South
Lead: ♦J

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♦J. East takes the ♦A and returns the ♦2.

Your 4 ♠ tricks, 2 ♥ tricks, 1 ♦ trick and 4 ♣ tricks are very easy to find. But that's only 11, so where in the world can you possibly find number 12?

With all those high ♦s falling on the first two tricks dummy's ♦ 9 has become a threat against West. If it should happen that West also holds the only ♥ stopper you can squeeze him in the red suits.

You are going to run your black suit winners, taking the ♣s first so you can be playing winners from your hand when you squeeze West.

On the last 2 ♣s West discards a ♦ and a ♥.

Now come to your hand with the ♠A and play the ♠ K Q.

You discard a small ♥ from dummy while West follows suit three times.

It is time.

West discards the ♥7, holding on to the ♦10.

Play your ♠J and watch what West discards.

If he holds on to the ♦10 you will discard dummy's useless ♦9 and hope the ♥s all fall under the ♥ A K.

If he discards the ♦10 then you throw dummy's small ♥ and dummy wins the last three tricks.

***Board 3***
South Deals
E-W Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 9 3<br>♥ K Q<br>♦ A K Q J 9 3<br>♣ Q 8 3 | |
| ♠ J 10 8 6<br>♥ A 8 4 2<br>♦ 5<br>♣ K 9 4 2 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ 7 4 2<br>♥ J 10 9 6 3<br>♦ 8 6 4<br>♣ J 6 |
| | ♠ A K Q 5<br>♥ 7 5<br>♦ 10 7 2<br>♣ A 10 7 5 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♣ |
| Pass | 2♦ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♥[2] |
| Pass | 6NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6NT by North
Lead: ♥J

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♥J. West wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

East plays low.

The solution is the Vienna Coup: a ♣ to the ♣A at trick 3.

Then start running the ♦ suit.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

East discards.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

West is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

***Board 4***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 9 3<br>♥ K 9 8 6 3<br>♦ A 6<br>♣ A K Q 5 | |
| ♠ Q J 10 6 4<br>♥ 10<br>♦ 10 9 7 4 2<br>♣ 8 2 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ A 8 5 2<br>♥ 4<br>♦ K Q 8 3<br>♣ J 10 9 3 |
| | ♠ K 7<br>♥ A Q J 7 5 2<br>♦ J 5<br>♣ 7 6 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| Pass | 3♣ | Pass | 3♥ |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

Play 5 ♥ winners and the ♠K.

Drum roll please.

West discards.

Play your ♥2 and dump dummy's ♦6.

East has no answer.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. East wins the ♠A and plays the ♦K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

East's ♦K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦Q also, so your ♦J is now a Threat against East. If he holds 4 ♣s you can squeeze him.